

Testing, testing. Live captioning by Ai-Media

SPEAKER:

R captioner has tested and I can get going.

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

And you can hear me?

SPEAKER:

Yes, Toby. Alright, good afternoon everyone. My name is Rebecca and I am the knowledge translation manager for the coordinating center. For those of you who are not familiar with what we do, we offer technical support and guidance for the demonstration projects and other higher education programs for students with intellectual disabilities.

Also joining me today from a colleague is my -- from the college is my colleague Sheila Johnson. We will be shared throughout the webinar to answer questions about technical problems and make sure that Toby, our presenter, sees any questions that you have. Please use the chat to SOS for any assistance you need.

And Toby is happy to answer any question as we go. So don't hold back! There may be time as well to answer questions. As with all webinars, this event is being live captioned and also recorded. In just a day or so, the captioned recording, transcript and a handy follow-up document that Tobey Partch-Davies prepared will be available on our website.

Also right now, available on our website, is the presentation packet. If you'd like to follow along, you can access that now and I think Sheila is putting that in the shot. I will go ahead and introduce Tobey, Tobey Partch-Davies is the director of the UNH-4U inclusive program. We are really excited to have Toby here presenting our Digital Badges which is another way for students to get the credit they deserve to show they learn some useful skills in college.

I think I can turn that over now.

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

Great, hi everyone! I am so glad to be here meant to talk about Digital Badges. I love what you said, Rebecca, about don't hold back. Because this work is so important and we need to move forward. Digital badging has been around for a while but is relatively new to flagship universities.

And institutions of higher education still so I am glad we are having a conversation about it. Before we do that now, I would like to provide a formal disclosure. At first, let me just tell you a little bit about

myself. My name is Tobey Partch-Davies and I am half of the national correlating center in the University of New Hampshire Institute on disability.

Thank you for being here, it is really an honor to precedent -- present and I hope you find this valuable. We really do want to be interactive so like Rebecca said, be sure to put your questions or comments in the chat box and leave your hand up if I can answer any questions along the way.

The formal disclosure you see on the screen here really is to identify that I am both the principal investigator of the program at UNH and also the parent of a young adult with intellectual disabilities who is actually in the program.

So that is why I am giving the disclosure. If you have any questions, comments or concerns, we do have a formal conflict of interest management plan in place. You can feel free to contact Kelly (Name) who is the director of the Institute. You can also contact Andrew (Name) who is the director and with that in mind, we can move on to the conversation.

I also want to acknowledge my colleagues at UNH-4U and RTM, specifically Mary Schuh who is our faculty liaison. As well as Brianna Hayward, are inclusive education facilitator and all of those colleagues. All of those professionals on our team were supposed to be co-presenting today but it is the first day of class and there were lots of scheduling conflicts.

So they cannot join us in the webinar but everyone on our team has done a lot to launch this program and this is our first year. Our model demonstration at UNH is designed for competitive employment, social development and independent living.

This is a photo of the hall which is a major place in campus. We are part of a system of state colleges and universities with UNH being our flagship university. Prior to being awarded this grant, which was funded for the first year in 2020, we spent many years collaborating with academic departments, administrative departments and student life departments on campus at UNH.

We also spent a lot of time working with our partners at New Hampshire location and the entire statewide interagency system, our statewide community practice as well as our New Hampshire counseling and development on disabilities.

So are in Tyler -- our entire model is based on collaboration. We are really confident that working together, we can develop lasting higher education opportunity that leads for true change for young adults with intellectual this abilities.

SPEAKER:

Before you go further, I would just like to launch this poll so we know who is here today. That would be good for you to know.

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

That would be fabulous.

SPEAKER:

Suggests two questions, then she can continue. The first is if you have attended a college webinar and the second is sharing how you identify primarily and who you are attending today. I will give everyone a minute or so. The pictures of the University of New Hampshire are beautiful too.

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

Thank you, it is a beautiful campus. It looks really pretty this morning with a fresh covering of snow.

SPEAKER:

I wondered if you had any snow cover or not.

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

Yeah, yeah.

SPEAKER:

I will give a couple of seconds, it looks like a few people are still working on this. Thank you to everyone who is taking the time to answer those questions. Three, two, one... I am going to end the pole. I will share lessee you can see who is here. Looks like a 50-50 split and primarily higher Ed staff faculty and then Samuel members. -- Family members.

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

And roughly half of not been here before, that is great.

SPEAKER:

Alright, take it away Toby!

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

Okay, let me). Okay! So moving on to our agenda for today, during this presentation I will provide you with an overview of our program here at UNH. I will share some operating definitions and literature on Digital Badges to give you a sense of the history and how Digital Badges have been applied.

Also discuss how they have aligned with our students programs of study and how we structure badges within our program and validate the skills and competencies these students obtain. I am also going to

discuss how badges transfer as a meaningful credential to career pathways as a huge outcome, anticipated outcome.

Especially with our partners being involved in this financial and programmatic ways, it is very important that we articulate how this will result in integrated employment. Finally, we will go over the value proposition and what they might offer you either as a student or employment.

Hopefully that sounds good and if there is something that I have not covered that is related to the topic, certainly add it if I have not been explicit enough. So first, our program, our framework for our inclusive higher education model. These four boxes represent the four constructs of our active living career pathways and social development. All of our students are registered in continuing education.

They are taking these classes in audit mode. So they are taking undergraduate classes and their articulated students who are taking these classes as an audit. In terms of programmatic positioning, we are located within the College of health and services at the Institute of disabilities. But we promote the model as an offering by UNH.

We want this to be viewed as a UNH offering rather than just the department. We work closely also with the community equity office on campus. And different academic units as well as student life department on campus.

All of our students register as continuing education, they audit the classes and are eligible to up to 11 credits per semester as a continuing education student. Each credit hour in the course add that for a 15 week semester to about 400 hours of clockwork. It is structured as a career program.

Students undergo comprehensive planning and do that part of a bridge program. Many of the students that are recruited or wish to apply to UNH participate in our bridges to college and career webinar series which had center planning.

After they apply and get accepted, they really deep dive and customize their own comprehensive way. Between the student's initial exploration of that and if they have already done that with their guidance counselor or teams in high school, or with the counselor, it is just more of that dose where they apply and again when they enroll and get accepted.

We do a really deep dive to get specific. All of that informs their occupational and academic aspirations. As well as the supports they need to succeed in the academic department and social development for living on campus. So although it has been under development, this model for multiple years, we applied for the 2015 tips and did not get that but there was so much enthusiasm in New Hampshire for this program and such small partnerships that we kept the momentum going.

But then with some other pilot money, we had patient and generous donors. We were able to launch our first cohort in the fall of 2021. The first day of their second semester is today. So it was really fun to be on campus this morning, submitting my coven test and seeing so many students on campus.

In several of the students are affiliated with the UNH-4U program. So thus far with a very small cohort, we have already touched in five months first the spring semester – fall semester going into spring semester, we have touched the college of liberal arts, business school, College of life sciences, agriculture, engineering, and also the University of New Hampshire in Manchester.

So for a very small cohort, that is really exciting. We have students taking classes in any number of colleges on campus. So we are excited about that. We also offer the option to live on campus in fully inclusive residence halls. Or a commuter option. So students can choose either or. We have noticed that the students who live on campus, their experiences just – I went to college myself.

As the commute student and I remember thinking "wow, they have so much fun on campus." But I was busy working so I never lived on campus and I will tell you that my observations with fire have been that there is just so much that resident life has to offer.

So we really encourage that with our students. I will say also that for interagency collaboration, are partners whether it is the interagency, they are involved throughout the entire process throughout the entire time the student is involved.

So everything from the application for admissions and supporting that application and aggression to cultivating the program of study. And how that is mixed with employment and service planning at the interagency level. It is very much a team process that is student driven but is informed by the strengths and passion of the student.

SPEAKER:

Just one quick question that somebody asked about the types of students who are enrolled. Whether they have certain types of disabilities. If anybody in the program with down syndrome or autism that can speak to that?

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

Our cohort is so small that I don't want to specify the disability but I will say by definition, everyone who is in the program has an intellectual disability and because they are affiliated with the agency, essentially anyone with a disability that qualifies for the community care waiver services and enters our program will have any number of disabilities.

So long as they can validate and justify the intellectual disability through documentation. So we are open to all of that. Whatever diagnosis they may have, as long as the functional issue with disability is addressed in the referral information. I hope that answers the question.

Okay, so I will go on to the next slide about Digital Badges. What are your badges? There's a lot of different terminology. The resource page that Rebecca mentioned in the beginning that is available actually references vocabulary used on the Digital Badge framework. So you will have access to that.

But essentially, the Digital Badge is an electronic representation of a skilled treatment or experience. This badge here is actually one of the badges that we have for our program. They get a badge for measurable postsecondary outcomes and outputs that lead to those.

So for the bridges program, we teach a tech class and solutions. We teach health and wellness and have guest presenters and other undergraduate students at UNH that are peer mentors in the program. So although that is all virtual, it is still inclusive. All of the students who have taken those courses earn badges.

If they earn all four badges, they get the master badge. This is what the badge looks like. They contains the digital information about the skill or experience. So people who see these badges or on the employer, to ascertain what assessments are needed. And what skills and competencies are defined and valued by the Digital Badge.

So we have to justify each of these badges and they are refuted by our governments or comprised of faculty and other administrators to determine if it is valuable and is this meaningful in terms of knowledgeable skills and gains that can be validated. And have the data to let us know what this actually means, what does this badge mean?

Once earned, the badge holder actually receives this in the email. Saying congratulations, you have earned your badge, whatever that match may be. – Badge. With that, they are able to share it on social media platforms, link the badge in their LinkedIn account so that they can open up their credentials to future employers. The employer can link onto the badge and I would love to demonstrate this in another session in the future. But they can click on the hyperlink and actually see what the project was that the student completed.

And look at the richness underneath that badge and how it was assessed and taught in the classroom or in the unit. So rather than just looking at a grade-point average for the person who graduated from whatever university, in this case the University of New Hampshire, they can see this rich range of experience that they had.

That can help employers assess fit and how they will move into the workplace.

SPEAKER:

I am sorry, did you want me to do the pool to find out if anyone is using Digital Badges?

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

I know some are using higher badges but if you are in higher Ed, let us know and that would be fabulous. Maybe you are not using them yet but your university is. Anything that you can use to qualify would be great.

SPEAKER:

These do not allow for personalization so they are not qualitative. While people are answering, there is a question in the chat. What platform is the Digital Badge on and are there dedicated platforms?

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

Yes, the one we use is credily (?) And one of the problems we have had is when they issue the badges and it goes out in the email, the student has to activate their free account and over the course of their different semesters, they start accumulating badges.

They are in full control of how they disseminate those. For some reason, let's say they misplace their password or can't figure how to get back in, if they go to our Digital Badge website at UNH, there is a link and they can work with our administrators to get access to that. So the University maintains archiving of all of the badges that are issued. And that is in the resource guide. Any other questions about that?

SPEAKER:

Not specifically. A bunch of comments so we will share those with you after. It is a mix of other people using the same site or some who are not using the badges but they hope to. I don't know, I can share.

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

And some say only students in the program. Yeah, it is interesting because in 2015 when we submitted our first tips we actually posed badges back in 2015 and they were less promoted. At that time, the University was not actually implementing Digital Badges at all. So one of the benefits of not getting funded the first year was that in 2020, the University had already embraced the idea of Digital Badges.

So it was great, we joined the effort that was already underway and we worked with our community engagement office to find all kinds of different pathways that students can access and the types of knowledge and skills that they need for their education plans.

Okay, I'm going to close out the pool here if that is okay, Rebecca. Alright. I want to give you some information that we actually harvested recently related to Digital Badges. Jane could not be here today so I want to share some of that with you. So Digital Badges have been used in a lot of different environments.

They can be used in academic settings and also nonacademic settings such as places of employment. One such example is Purdue University which tested the effect of implementing a Digital Badge for improving the use of hands-on laboratory skills.

That project found significant improvement in student knowledge, their confidence level, their experience and lab equipment. Resulting in less breakage and more lab techniques. That study actually also incorporated people who experienced disabilities and how to make accommodations in those experiences. So students were also earning those badges.

Another example is IBM. They were trying to increase completion in their courses and found that making Digital Badges available increased attendance for online courses by hundred and 25%. Completion can increase by 226%.

It later developed into a partnership with Northeastern University which is in Massachusetts and they facilitated IBM badges to receive college credit. So that particular arrangement requires very clear specifications of one is allowed in the sector and clear criteria.

So those are some examples. Another example our community college systems and those are experimenting with Digital Badges from 15 to 20 years and what I found interesting and relevant was how they could address barriers to higher education. So not always but commonly, commuter students or adult students who are going to community college systems and juggling work and family life. So Digital Badges have shown to be a great way to break down different learning domains into more educational content and chunks of content so that the learner can maybe start without the foundation skills.

Working on the foundation's global lead to a more intermediate skill and by breaking it down into smaller sections, that has been a way to help address barriers so the student can build confidence while at the same time, putting them on a path related to their career pathway.

The other aspect of this is that badges have been shown to benefit not only students or the learner but also the issuer. You will know on the prior slides that showed the Digital Badge and the brand, companies that get involved in this or institutions of higher education that awarded the badge, their brand is identified. So imagine all of the brands that might come from an IBM experience being shared

on LinkedIn for all of these different badges. Then the incentive to the student is something very marketable and transferable to the skill or type of job.

Because the learner is in charge of disseminating that information, they can pick and choose what badges really apply. A lot of times, when looking for employment and interviewing, you have to tune your resume so the actual learner can tweak what badges show on their resume and that is really cool. Any questions about any of the contents that I have shared less far about badges and some of the literature?

Okay, what are the implications of Digital Badges and higher education efforts? First, Digital Badges allow us to target specific knowledge and skill sets along the learning pathway. We can break down the skill set into smaller or shorter learning objectives specific to a learner or their learner domain.

Consider this very similar to a task analysis and breaking down an entire job or learning objective into multiple components for systematic instruction or coworker, on-the-job training. This is very similar when applied to a job and education environment in conjunction with the faculty and academic coaches.

This is commonly referred to as stacking. You can stack badges vertically. So showing a hierarchy or horizontally which is showing a range of skills. Doing that in conjunction with applying for assisted technology solutions for the learner and accommodations and modifications that are necessary to improve results and opportunities for the hierarchy.

Building incrementally or across a range of domains towards knowledge and skills. But for badges to be meaningful, we need the evidence of what and how much was gained for the knowledge and skills of the learner. So we don't want to just say they participated in this class and got a badge.

What is the goal of the badge? We are committing ourselves to holding the University accountable to make sure it is being held to that so we collect the data to prove that this is what the student actually learn. So we do that first by justifying the badge.

At UNH we have four levels and this is a tiered system, right? So this first level is the foundational level. So very basic beginner fundamentals in articulating the practice. Level 2 is intermediate or looking at some of the next level up of skills.

Then it just moves further along as they specialize in practice whereas the fourth is really mastering that competency based master. Becoming the trainer for licensure or mastering program language. What's of different examples and ways to justify it based on what the actual content is. So there's a lot of flexibility in how we are framing this so that regardless of the field where the practice, there is a way

to justify the badges to translate that into a badge that is worthwhile.

Okay, then this is how we access and do our learner assessments. We have a couple of ways to do that, first, this is a step process that is by association. Often times, this has to do with participation in an actual activity or recognition badge. So imagine a student going to a national conference and participating in a roundtable discussion for poly science student participating in some sort of debate or being a participant at a debate.

So they would get a participation badge for just being there but if they lead a student organization in a debate process and organized that debate, that would be something more substantial in fact they did, right? So there are levels within these three levels.

The second one is the actual learning which is a great way to score and that level is going to be meaningful in the next level. So an example of that could be a grade for writing responses where for writing responses my class, the student had writing responses that contained all the components of the rubric and what the faculty was looking for.

The next level up is competency. It is demonstration of his skill in a high-stakes environment. That might be Proctor assessment, or a certification. Hopefully I did not go through that too quickly, any questions there Rebecca?

SPEAKER:

There are a few questions, thank you for asking. One question was "are the badges standardized?"

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

Correct, they are not. We are not creating a badge for everyone that we have, they are definitely standardized. I will talk through this on the next few slides about how we frame these. So I will tell you that UNH, we have her own badge system and we very much wanted to be a part of the badging community at UNH.

But as sort of the path of least resistance, we have framed this to coincide with their programs of study so that we can have that collaboration with faculty and talk about what we referred to as 21st-century skill sets.

I can zoom into the next slide and show you what I mean by that and then we can go back to those questions. So we have work-related skills that we are focusing in on. In very meaningful and applied waves as well as career specific knowledge and skills that are customized towards the occupation or career direction.

That is done through academic enrichment so it is the classes they were holding related on what interests the student has for their occupational outcome. Then we have what we call career and professional success. Which we are working on from day one.

Those are career related efforts that the student has and that is more applied work that they are doing. Not in the class but in their experience at UNH. Then the work-related skills are across a number of different domains and the domains consist of learning and innovation which consists of things like creativity, innovation, creative thinking, problem-solving, collaboration, media, tech fluency.

All of these things that a worker often means in everyday work environments. So this is our framework for how these first two rows – that is our framework for what every student goes through. Underneath, it gets specified and customized for what the actual student needs but the band – badges are standardized.

I can take another question related to the prior slide.

SPEAKER:

Okay, somebody also asked how many badges you offer. You did not just say that, did you?

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

We are accumulating them and building as we go. I hope to be done with what I refer to as the 21st century badges soon. We are not there yet and we prioritize. I will talk more on this in a minute. We prioritize based on what our first cohort was targeting and based on what their program of study consisted up for the first semester.

So we are not putting limits on how many. What we don't want to do though and I know the University does not want us to do this, is to duplicate. Right? If there is something that is already available that the University has approved, we will first explore that option.

So we don't want to create a tangled mess and reduce the quality or integrity of the badging structure at UNH. So right now, our badges at UNH-4U are specific UNH-4U badges for these other skill sets.

That is what we have to do for now which requires a lot of work and these higher education system processes. It is incremental so we are doing it this way now and hope that one day, at one point, at some point I should say. We will be able to make it open and meaningful.

Because as other faculty and industry said, a lot of undergraduate students need these work-related skills. It is not unique to just the students in the UNH-4U program.

SPEAKER:

Somebody did clarify that there are some badges that are only for UNH-4U students and some that are only for UNH students. Her

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

Yeah, there is overlap and if you go on our website, I will include that. I think I already did in the resource page. You will see everything there. We have things on sustainability, things on IT, project management. There are all kinds of things. Social and emotional health.

There are all kinds of things and a wide array of badges. So the idea is that anyone, whether it is a UNH-4U student or someone else in the community who is looking to change jobs or get back into a new career area, each of those badges will say who it is available to and what the pathway is. The idea is that there are numerous entry points, not just a traditional four-year degree or a masters level thing from the University.

There are numerous pathways to get the education that people need and that translates into a meaningful credential for what the person is looking for.

SPEAKER:

Okay and someone is asking if you are mapping the 21st century skills onto the framework?

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

And ACE meaning the accreditation standards?

SPEAKER:

It says are you accrediting onto the standard skills?

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

I think the answer is yes. These are skills that people need in the 21st century so I think that is what you are referring to.

SPEAKER:

Okay, will you get more into how students demonstrate mastery?

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

Yes.

SPEAKER:

And Mary, if you could hold one second and we will see if someone gets to your question.

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

And I will start moving faster and hold questions because I see we only have 20 minutes left. I will get to the questions but I want to go through this as well. So in terms of Digital Badges and how they align, they align with the center plan and we know what the student wants to do in terms of employment. One of the skills they need from the occupational quest that they are interested in?

Then what we do is work with the student to identify courses and get that experience and knowledge. Then we make a faculty request for the student to actually participate in the class. Once that student is accepted, we then do a crosswalk between the syllabi or syllabus and the badging taxonomy.

So let's use an earth science sort of course going through and finding out okay, is there critical thinking component? Is there and being able to measure and do some testing of the things the student may need to do. So we do a crosswalk between what the syllabus says and the taxonomy.

Then we code the syllabus for all of the badges that might apply to career elements and the 21st century. I can think of several examples but one is the ability to work with others and the ability to work with people with diverse backgrounds. Several of our students really earned that badge because of what they are studying.

Like I said, they are included in undergraduate classes and can do this by way of assignments in the class. They are getting graded even though they are auditing. But then they also have these real world and real life experiences on the college campus where they are engaged in supervised working that is not necessarily a class but is how we framed working.

Let's say one student is working with the student organization and is responsible for sustainable programming for the student organization. So that student is learning about project management and using a workflow. Working with others or learning a lot of things. So we are applying this again in both academic and nonacademic settings.

That is a great example because it is what students are doing. In the classroom for some and other times it is outside of the classroom in student life or on campus. So those courses that we take, we are collaborating with a lot of the faculty and the faculty grades for regular assignment.

Also, we collaborate with which badges apply and faculty weighs in on what they believe according to the taxonomy that the student actually deserves. So badges are commonly stocked. So you can stack horizontally or you can stock vertically.

Remember this is a hierarchically and this is the range. So these are the 21st century skill sets. So the

foundational skills would be analyzing media literacy and other literacy. The next level up would be to create a media product. Then they may have to do a summation on the drill they had to do for a particular body of mechanics and thought could be immediate product. Information literacy would be the next level up.

This is the vertical stacking and it gets more complex as you go. And over here, it is working across. To get the actual master badge and technology skills, they would have to accomplish all of this and we would need data to be able to earn that.

So maybe media is not a huge thing for their occupation but nevertheless, it is something they should know about. So we target the things they really need according to their plans. Then we go heavy on the ones that they really need to have an opportunity to earn all kinds of badges from the badging taxonomy.

Okay, here's an example. So remember if you look back at the prior slide, this first section is the career domain skills and the next level are the four constructs. So this is an example of a student's scope. So we have the actual learning about physical education for the student.

So the student has to wear about teaching practice, has to learn about national standards in physical education and think about what are the standards in physical education. Part of the career related aspect is lesson plans. Learning how to create lesson plans or collaborate with the teacher on creating a lesson plan. Co-teaching and learning the rules of sports to then be able to demonstrate to learners, other awareness, students in elementary set up how to actually play the game or perform the physical education practice.

Then we have an internship or applied learning component for our model where the internship may occur for the student and already has in elementary school. So that is the career specific orientation. Then the work-related skills and how this plays out is both for social development and it just so happens to develop from a career standpoint, a student involved in their student organization relayed into an occupation.

The student happens to be part of a physical education organization. So he is both networking with other students that are at UNH and getting to know contacts, friends, networks and experience on campus. Cultivating social skills but also making connections to the material and resume writing specifics or leads for job opportunities from that organization.

Then regular etiquette and soft skills. In the independent living ties then and a lot of these are work-related skills but this is where we put the independent living skills and self advocacy and determination. Those skills around independent living in general. Ability to get around, learning

transportation systems on campus, taking care of their own finances.

This is all very customizable. Again, those are all in seminars so we are badging for all of those things. So will a student share and disseminate badges for independent living rules? Probably not.

But they may report that back to somebody who is helping to support the financing of you know, their participation in the program because it shows that it is making a difference and that is evaluation. We are tracking change scores for all of these things and outcomes. So, I just love this picture by the way!

The added value and this is my last slide of content for the badges. This is really the cost of higher education. So when I told my team all the time as we do not just want to have people go to a school on campus. Is there value from just coming here? Of course.

It is an opportunity to be in the same age peer environment in the same city and the experience that comes from just attending school. That is priceless on its own. But another piece of it is been able to go to college and having not translate into really meaningful occupations and passion to prepare them. So we are zeroing in on both of those objectives.

The other piece of badges is really aligning with the evidence. So colleges and universities now we need to be more flexible. We want to keep all of our accreditation that needs to be in place and we need to maintain our reputation of being flexible. But we know we also have to adapt a bit more in the changing economy and marketplace.

Hoping to appeal to workforce demands with employers in the leader sector. While at the same time, maintaining those important things that universities need to maintain. Stature and all of that. The other place that is part of value equation is that it can be customized.

So in other words, what I mean by that is the individual person from the justifying badge, they can break things down and chunk things out. Into micro, you know, areas of study to help build that confidence like I was seen earlier. So that is really exciting and the transferability into the job market.

When it means to be able to show a portfolio or for a student to be able to do that and illustrate that through their portfolio. Really value adding and becoming more confident with that. Just the ability to be here on campus and we are learning in authentic campus life. So we are turning their syllabi upside down and students in classes are all participating in the class and the assessments that we are doing. But we will add another layer on and transfer it into badges as well.

So far so good. We have had great experiences this semester and with that, I will pause to see if there are questions.

SPEAKER:

Lives I raised her hand and asked a question and you may need to type in the chat. It says you are muted. (Name), you may need to type your message in the chat please. Let's see if there were others. Did I miss anybody else's question?

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

Oh thank you for whoever he shared the acronym. That is probably a good idea to do, yes. I cannot say that I have done that but certainly it is along those lines for sure. And actually, I would like to hear more from whoever posted that and if you are actually doing that, could you on microphone yourself and share seeking benefit?

SPEAKER:

I can try, I think the setting say that people can't talk. Nancy, I just tried to unmute you if you'd like to talk. Nancy (Name) who taped those interesting questions?

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

Is everyone? Oh, there she is.

SPEAKER:

Can you hear me?

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

Yes.

SPEAKER:

As you are describing it, it sounded exactly like the 21st century skill set. And you know, I know digital badging, contract, when I first heard of this webinar, I did not realize how closely it would align with the typical Digital Badge chain scenario. We are not using it on our campus but there were a number of organizations in the area that were using it.

It seems to have particular use in the areas of stem fields where you can really measure and quantify the learning in a skill set. You know, we just have kind of a lot of and have seen a lot of success in using it for other settings.

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

Right, what about other people in higher education who may have – about 50% in higher education hi Digital Badges on their campus. Do have any comments to share about how it is being used in your institution?

SPEAKER:

What people decide if they want to share, another person asked what the pacing was for the badges. Does it take a semester? A year?

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

So, we really had the pilot the first semester because we have never done this before and have the conceptual framework and justification and all those things to have never done it before. We wanted to pilot it first and knew going in based on the syllabi and program of study what badges we were aiming for.

The semester just concluded so we are going in and scrutinizing the data that staff logged and also that faculty log. We are determining, you know, what levels are plausible and feeding that back to faculty.

So it is not done but in the next wave, the next semester, when I am hoping to be able to do is pick up the pace and work on the quality. After all, this is the first time we have done it. Then we will move on to next semester and hopefully be in a place where we have the badges, after a period of time, justify all of them.

As they are awarded, it will be rapid demand and when they get them they will not necessarily have to wait until the end of the semester for some. Others they may. Then they start accumulating them so they don't have to wait for two years to find out how many badges they have.

They can actually use them for meaningful purposes throughout their time at the program while they accumulate.

SPEAKER:

Thank you. I don't know if you can see the chat or not?

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

I can, I just opened it up. Any other questions? I would love a question from a student or parent if there are any students or parents still on the webinar.

SPEAKER:

While somebody asked, I don't know if you can answer but this is probably from a family. Do you know how many other college programs are using badges?

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

I don't. I know and we could probably find that out. I think that is something we could go back to possibly. Maybe on the resource page we could do research and find that out. I know in our cohort, we do have a couple of different universities that are looking into that, two or three of them.

In fact, I was just on the phone with one this morning and we do have a question from a parent.

SPEAKER:

While you read those, I will put the last poll up so if anybody has to run, we just wanted feedback. It helps us plan future webinars and things like that.

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

Yes, so Karen is asking insane she is apparent. That is great, excellent. Okay and another parent of a 15-year-old and you are glad you attended, great. You will have access to the sides and it would be posted on the college website. My contact information is at the end so if our team could be helpful, I will put that slide up now so you can see it.

If we can be helpful in answering questions, our email is there and we will certainly respond. Any other questions that you see that I did not get to? I know we only have about two minutes left?

SPEAKER:

No other questions, just a reminder that Sheila sent to everyone. You will all get a follow-up email about this webinar with a link to all of the resources that were available. It seems like this is a topic people are interested in so I would make sure you are in our mailing list and follow us on social media. Because we have new information to share.

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

Great, excellent. Why want to thank everyone for participating and asking really good questions. This is all pretty new to us but we have had this framework down for a while and are super excited. We are doing a really rigorous evaluation honor project program.

So we hope to be able to share some outcomes and ideally have some of our students present their experience and what they gained from it down the round.

SPEAKER:

That would be super cool! Yeah.

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

Yeah, the student voice is super important and the faculty voice to, right?

SPEAKER:

Yes and thank you for all of the time you took today on the first day of classes. We look forward to hearing more about the work that you are doing in the higher education network to see how this works for students. Thanks everyone for coming today. We will see you soon, I hope.

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

Great, thank you.

SPEAKER:

Goodbye.

TOBEY PARTCH-DAVIES:

Goodbye.

SPEAKER:

Rebecca, I will stay on for a minute.

Live captioning by Ai-Media